



4-25-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=uoYlnV1pst4
Publication Date	2023-04-26T10:31:48Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Board/Council: Muncie Community Schools Board of Education

Meeting Date: April 25, 2023

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee session was held immediately prior to calling the regular meeting to order. A statutory public hearing for a proposed capital project was formally convened later during the meeting [00:54:39](#) and is detailed under Section 4).

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The presiding officer called the meeting to order, initiated a moment of silence, and led the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:04](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neil, Mr. Heater, Dr. Bales, Mr. Urban, Mr. Lowe, and the presiding officer/CEO.
 - **Absent:** Mrs. Barnes Griffin (traveling).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Board President / Chair.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Conducted a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:04](#). Recognized newly hired staff members: Melinda McComas (Preschool Lead Teacher, Grissom Elementary) and Shaylee Smith (Elementary Teacher, Northview Elementary) [00:06:31](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The prior meeting minutes were included in the board packet and approved via the consent agenda [00:35:49](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:06](#) **Special Education Program Overview & Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jenny Smithson, Special Education Director (accompanied by Sarah Price, Emily Collins, and Jeff Helm from the Youth Opportunity Center).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Director Smithson provided an extensive overview of district special education services, demographics, and funding sources. The district's December 1 child count stands at 1,055 students with Individualized Education Programs (IEPs). Funding mechanisms include Part B federal grants, Medicaid administrative claiming, and Medicaid fee-for-service (yielding over \$193,000 year-to-date for speech, occupational, and physical therapies). The presentation highlighted the creation of an upcoming high school employment skills program at the MAC (running a district print shop), a super-senior community internship program for students aging out up to age 22, and a new grades 3-6 therapeutic day treatment program in partnership with the Youth Opportunity Center (YOC). Jeff Helm of the YOC also spoke to celebrate a 25-year partnership with the district [00:25:21](#).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board action required.
- [00:31:48](#) **Chief Executive Officer (CEO) Report**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Lee Ann Kwiatkowski, CEO.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Announced that Kyra Zik (Westview Elementary) received the Ball Brothers Foundation Excellence in Teaching Award for Delaware County. Noted a ribbon-cutting at Northside for PDS immersive classrooms and recognized Nora Quirk as an Indiana Academic All-Star. Announced the "Blast Off to Kindergarten" community engagement tour dates. Reported that a student brought a gun to Muncie Central High School earlier in the morning and commended the security team (including Robert Scafe) and administrative staff for successfully confiscating the weapon during routine security checks without incident.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; accepted by voice vote.

- **00:34:49 Consent Agenda Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board President / Brad Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covered approval of prior meeting minutes, personnel recommendations, fundraisers, a food service management contract renewal, and claim approvals.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Moved by Dr. Bales, seconded by Mr. Urban).
- **00:36:26 New Course Addition: MCHS "Exploring Education Professions"**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Introduced a new Career and Technical Education (CTE) intro course initiated by the Indiana Department of Education targeting 9th and 10th graders to explore careers in education (teachers, counselors, administrators). Mr. Shametta will teach the course at Muncie Central High School.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Moved by Mr. Lowe, seconded by Dr. Bales).
- **00:37:36 Monthly Financial Report (March 2023)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reported that the state basic grant remains on pace at approximately \$43.6 million. Total checkbook balance across all funds exceeded \$36.1 million at the end of March, with the education fund balance over \$16.2 million. The state loan balance was reported down to \$10.3 million.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:34:15 Bid Approval: Interactive Display Boards**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome / Steve Spradlin.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented bids for interactive display boards to upgrade and replace aging overhead LCD projectors in every classroom at Muncie Central High School using grant funds.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:45:29 Request to Advertise Additional Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome, Chief Financial Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested permission to advertise an additional appropriation hearing for next month, covering \$2.5 million for the Rainy Day Fund (2023) and \$2.52 million for the Debt Service Fund. Jerome confirmed that these actions are necessitated by the late approval of 2023 bonds and will **not** result in any increase in local tax rates.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Moved by Mr. Heater, seconded by Mr. Lowe).
 - **00:48:54 Support Staff Compensation & Retention Package**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Committee (Jim Lowe, Brittany Bales, Dave Heater) / Brad Jerome / Dr. Young.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed a comprehensive support staff compensation package addressing labor market inflation and staffing turnover. The plan delivers a \$219,000 salary increase (approximately a 4.1% increase). Additionally, it establishes a \$500 end-of-year retention stipend and two \$500 semester attendance/paid-time-off stipends (totaling up to \$1,500 in potential stipends per qualifying support staff member).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (Moved by Dr. Bales, seconded by Mr. Heater).
 - **00:45:31 Parking Easement Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal Counsel (Mr. Day) / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed a parking easement agreement with adjusted language from legal counsel. Approval was sought subject to final review and sign-off by administration and counsel.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved subject to final legal review by Voice Vote (Moved by Board Member, seconded by Mr. Heater).
 - **00:54:39 PUBLIC HEARING: 2023 Bond Project Phase 2 (Muncie Central Stadium Improvements)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Jerome / Mr. Root (Schmidt & Associates).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The regular meeting was temporarily recessed to convene a statutory public hearing pursuant to IC 20-26-7-37 for a \$6.1 million capital project (Phase 2 of the 2023 Bond Project). The project includes constructing a north-side athletic building featuring locker rooms, office space, and a restroom/concession facility, complementing ongoing track and turf renovations at Muncie Central High School. Jerome confirmed the project is **tax neutral** within the debt service fund.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None. The floor was opened for public comment, but no members of the public stepped forward to speak **01:03:09**.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition (Post-Hearing):**
 - Public hearing adjourned by voice vote.
 - Project Resolution **Passed Unanimously** (Moved by Mr. Urban, seconded by Dr. O'Neill).
 - Reimbursement Resolution **Passed Unanimously** (Moved/Seconded and approved by voice vote).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(No general open public comment period took place near the conclusion of the meeting, as public input was specifically solicited and received during the earlier statutory public hearing session).

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Board President reflected on the 5-year history of the school board partnership, highlighting community investments, capital milestones (Field House, stadium, and upcoming YMCA pool partnerships), and collaborative financing successes.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote following a motion and second [01:14:33](#).
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